JAMES MITCHELL

Backend Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a backend engineer with five years of experience building scalable APIs and microservices for fintech and e-commerce platforms. I've spent most of my career working with Python and Go, focusing on database optimization and system reliability. I enjoy solving performance problems and mentoring junior developers through code reviews and pair programming sessions. Based in Cambridge, I'm looking for roles where I can contribute to meaningful projects while continuing to develop my infrastructure knowledge.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer

Nexus Finance Ltd

nexusfinance.co

Cambridge, United Kingdom

June 2023 - Present

Designed and implemented a new payment processing microservice in Go that reduced transaction latency by 40 percent, serving over 2 million daily requests with 99.95 percent uptime.

Led the migration of legacy monolithic codebase to event-driven architecture using Kafka, improving system scalability and enabling independent deployment of services.

Optimized PostgreSQL queries and introduced database indexing strategies that cut average query time from 850ms to 120ms across the main reporting service.

Mentored three junior backend engineers through code reviews, architecture discussions, and weekly pairing sessions, helping them progress from junior to mid-level roles.

Backend Engineer

Velocity Commerce Systems

velocitycommerce.io

Cambridge, United Kingdom

February 2021 - May 2023

Built RESTful APIs using Python Flask and FastAPI to support the e-commerce platform, handling order processing, inventory management, and customer data endpoints.

Implemented comprehensive unit and integration tests using pytest, achieving 82 percent code coverage and reducing production bugs by 35 percent within the first year.

Collaborated with DevOps to containerize applications using Docker and deploy services to Kubernetes clusters, improving deployment frequency from monthly to daily releases.

Conducted database performance analysis and implemented connection pooling with Redis, reducing database load during peak traffic periods by 45 percent.

Junior Backend Engineer

CloudServe Solutions

cloudserve.net

Cambridge, United Kingdom

July 2019 - January 2021

Developed backend features for a cloud storage platform using Python and contributed to API endpoints for file upload, retrieval, and user authentication systems.

Wrote SQL migrations and worked with MySQL databases to maintain data integrity and implement new features for multi-tenant architecture.

Participated in on-call rotations and debugged production issues, gaining practical experience with logging systems, monitoring tools, and incident response procedures.

Assisted with documenting API specifications using Swagger and OpenAPI standards, improving communication between backend and frontend development teams.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, United Kingdom

2017 - 2019

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, United Kingdom

2013 - 2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, SQL, Bash

Frameworks and Libraries: FastAPI, Flask, SQLAlchemy, Gin

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB

Messaging and Events: Kafka, RabbitMQ, Apache Pulsar

Infrastructure and DevOps: Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, Git, CI/CD pipelines

Tools and Practices: Linux, REST APIs, microservices architecture, system design, Agile